

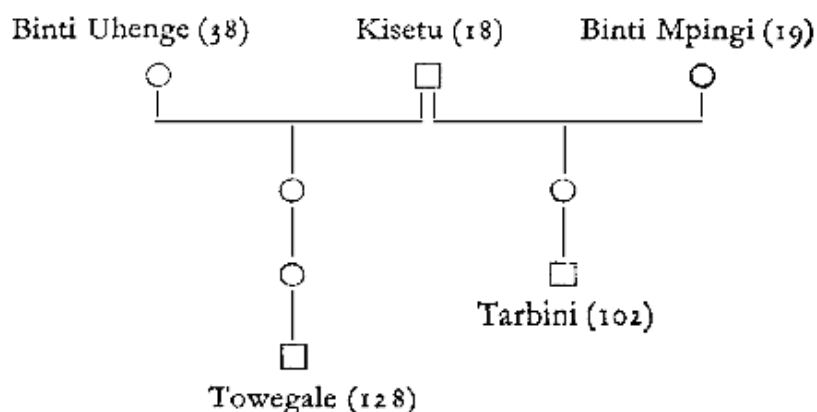
[Return to Search](#)**Ubena of the Rivers****Author(S):** Culwick, A. T. (Arthur Theodore), Culwick, G. M., Mrs., Kiwanga, Towegale**Document Type:** Book**Original Page:** 199**Culture (OWC):** [Bena \(FN31\)](#)**Region:** Africa**Sub Region:** Eastern Africa**Field Date:** 1931-1933**Coverage Date:** 1928-1933**Place Coverage**

Ulanga and Kilombero Districts, Morogoro Region, Tanzania

Section Title(S): CHAPTER IX SOCIAL ORGANISATION

Sometimes, of course, generations get mixed and relationship terms more appropriate to the relative ages of the people using them may be substituted for the true ones. For instance, Towegale inherited his seventh wife, Samweti binti Mbago (135), from a man whom he called his *mama* (elder brother), but who was really an absurdly young *yaya* (maternal uncle), for Towegale's mother also called him brother. The relationship was as follows:

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Similarly, Ndaliwali was called Binti Bilali's (39) maternal uncle because she was of suitable age to marry his son Mtengera, but really Ndaliwali and she were cross-cousins of the same generation.

Where no such adjustment for age takes place, somewhat amusing situations may arise. The writers observed two middle-aged women kneel to greet quite a young woman, who received the mark of respect as her due, with nonchalant self-possession. The matter was soon explained. "These are my children! Their father and my husband are brothers, the sons of two sisters." Again, a half-grown youth addressed (half jokingly, it must be admitted) a young man only a few years his senior as "father," because the latter had taken to wife the young sister of the former's mother. But joke or no joke, the "father" had to feed his "son" when called upon by him to do so, when they were both travelling with the writers.

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